Rajasthan is on the first position in this ranking.

One should have Jan Aadhaar card to avail the benefit of free medicine scheme. The OPD and IPD patients have to bring their Jan Aadhaar card at all the government hospitals. The doctors treating patients through these cards have all the details about the disease, treatment, tests done so far. Besides this, record of the patient's disease is found at one place. This scheme benefits not only patients receiving free medicines but also researchers studying affordable treatments for various diseases. The vast repository of disease-related data aids in finding solutions for complex issues, promising improved patient care.

It is not that in free medicine scheme, medicines are given for common diseases such as cold, flu, cough etc and fulfilling the formality of the scheme, but medicines are provided free of cost to patients with serious diseases such as heart, cancer, diabetes, respiratory and asthma.

Among the beneficiaries, Antima, a 19-year-old from Jaipur, has been battling lung cancer for two years, receiving Rs 7 lakh worth of treatment covered entirely by the Chiranjeevi Scheme. Similarly, Mohan Lal Meena from Ramsinghpura underwent kidney transplant and the expenses were covered by the scheme. Mohan Lal expressed gratitude for not having to sell his assets to afford treatment, highlighting the scheme's life-changing impact.

Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot is committed to ensure that patients never face issues due to lack of medicines. This commitment led to an expansion of the free medicine scheme's scope, a total of 2472 items including 1331 medicines, 956 surgical items, and 185 sutures. It is to be mentioned that Rajasthan ranks first in the entire country in regard to free medicines.

The scheme's success is evident from the Rs 7439 crore spent on medicine procurement between October 2, 2011, and June 30, 2023, benefiting over 119 crore patients. In the current fiscal year, more than 2.57 crore individuals have benefited, with the government spending Rs 432.58 crore in just three months.

SUSTAINING SUCCESS
ENSURING MEDICINE AVAILABILITY IN CHALLENGING AREAS

It is but obvious that maintaining stocks of medicines at hospitals, PHCs etc in remote areas is a very challenging, but the Rajasthan government made a special effort as the entire scheme is dependent on the availability of the medicines. A provision is already made in the state budget and NHC PIP budget. Many times it is noticed that some medicine runs out of stock or faces problem on timely supply. Looking at this issue, 10% of the total budget is kept separately for the local purchase. With this budget, the important medicines are purchased immediately at the local level so that patients do not face any problem for the medicines.

In the current fiscal year, more than 2.57 crore individuals have benefited under free medicine scheme, with the government spending Rs 432.58 crore in just three months.

S.No.	Level of Medical Institution	Type of Medical Institution	Medicines	Surgical	Sutures	Total
1.	Tertiary Level Medical Institution	Medical Colleges and hospitals attached to them	1331	956	185	2472
2.	Secondary level Medical Institution	District/Sattelite/ sub district hospitals	833	421	73	1327
		Community Health Centres	646	144	39	829
3.	Third Level Medical Institution	Primary Health Centres	466	91	18	575
		Sub Centres (Changed name Health Wellness Centre where CHO is posted)	111	10	0	121
		Sub Centres	40	10	0	50

ESSENTIAL DRUG LIST (EDL) COMPARISION	
RAJASTHAN EDL	1331
GOVT. OF INDIA EDL	544

MUKHYAMANTRI NISHULK NIROGI RAJASTHAN (TESTS) SCHEME
RAJASTHAN'S PIONEERING FREE TESTING INITIATIVE

Rajasthan spearheaded free testing initiatives, becoming the first state to introduce such schemes. In 2013, Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot expanded upon the success of the free medicine scheme by launching the free tests scheme. Originally offering 271 tests, this